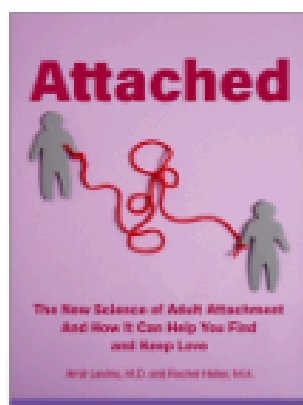




ATTACHED

The New Science of Adult Attachment And
How It Can Help You Find and Keep Love

Amir Levine, M.D. and Rachel Heller, M.A.



The Big “So What”

Why do some romantic relationships thrive while others fail? This book explains the science behind adult attachment, the reasons for common relationship challenges, with practical strategies for building stronger, healthier, and more fulfilling relationships. Whether you're single, dating, or in a long-term relationship, *Attached* provides actionable tips to help you find and sustain the love life you desire.



The Science of Adult Attachment



The attachment theory explains why people behave the way they do in relationships.

- There are 3 main attachment styles—secure, anxious, and avoidant—that shape how we connect, communicate, and seek intimacy. It applies to all types of relationships, including romance, friendships, family, and colleagues.
- In this book, psychologists Amir Levine and Rachel Heller focus on romantic relationships in adults, using their experience in psychiatry, neuroscience, and social-organizational psychology to translate scientific research into practical insights and strategies for romantic relationships.



This summary presents the insights in 3 parts:

- The origins and foundations of adult attachment theory;
- The behaviors, traits, and challenges of each attachment style; and

KEY QUOTES

“By understanding that people vary greatly in their need for intimacy and closeness and that these differences create clashes, attachment findings offered us a new way of looking at romantic relationships.”

“Understanding attachment styles is an easy and reliable way to understand and predict people’s behavior in any romantic situation.”

“Although we all have a basic need to form close bonds, the way we create them varies.”

- Practical strategies to find a compatible partner, navigate relationships effectively, and nurture secure, fulfilling relationships.



Part 1: Understanding the Adult Attachment Theory



Origins of Attachment Styles



John Bowlby and Mary Ainsworth developed the original attachment theory, focusing on the bond between infants and their primary caregivers. This bond is crucial for a child's safety and survival, and it shapes how they handle relationships as adults.

- Ainsworth's experiments, including the "Strange Situation" test, identified 3 main attachment styles in children:
 - (i) *Anxious*: The baby is distressed when the mother leaves, and is both happy and angry when she returns.
 - (ii) *Avoidant*: The baby seems indifferent when the mother departs or returns, but is actually stressed inwardly.
 - (iii) *Secure*: The baby is upset when the mother leaves but quickly calms down upon her return.
- Such attachment styles were initially thought to come solely from childhood interactions. However, research has since shown that genes and life experiences also play a part.



Adults have been found to exhibit similar attachment styles. These affect how we manage intimacy, conflict, dependence, and autonomy in adult romantic relationships.

- Anxious: People with this style crave intimacy, often worrying about their relationships, and fearing their partners may not reciprocate their feelings.
- Avoidant: People with this style see intimacy as a threat to their independence and prefer to keep a distance in relationships.

KEY QUOTES

"The attachment theory.... allowed us to learn not only what goes 'wrong' in relationships but also what goes 'right'."

"An entire mosaic of factors comes together to create this attachment pattern: our early connection with our parents, our genes, and also something else—our romantic experiences as adults."

- Secure: People with this style are comfortable with intimacy, and are typically warm and loving.



Every person has an attachment style.

- Such styles tend to remain stable, though they can change over time for about 1 in 4 people.
- People with secure attachments generally report higher relationship satisfaction compared to others. The keys to a thriving relationship include: developing a secure attachment style, finding a secure partner, or helping your current partner adopt a secure style.



Dependency in Relationships



Challenging the self-sufficiency myth: There's a long-standing misconception that people should be emotionally self-sufficient. In the 1940s, experts advised against "coddling" children, saying it would lead to emotional instability.

- Early attachment research challenged this view. For example, infants that lacked attachment figures showed abnormal development even though they were well-nourished, proving that healthy development requires both emotional bonds and physical care.
- Some modern self-help advice also promotes strict independence and avoiding emotional entanglements.



Yet, human beings are biologically wired for connection.

- Our emotional bonds affect our physiological responses. Studies show that, once attached, partners regulate each other's blood pressure, heart rate, breathing, and hormone levels.
- Healthy dependence on a partner offers comfort and reduces stress, making you more autonomous and resilient.
 - (i) Dr. James Coan found that women felt less stressed when holding their husband's hands while awaiting a mild electric shock.

KEY QUOTES

"Time and again, research shows that the best predictor of happiness in a relationship is a secure attachment style."

"We live in a culture that seems to scorn basic needs for intimacy, closeness, and especially dependency while exalting independence. We tend to accept this attitude as truth— to our detriment."

"Dependency is a fact; it is not a choice or a preference."

- (ii) Dr. Brooke Feeney found that couples who feel supported by their partners reported higher self-esteem, better mood, and greater confidence in achieving their goals.



Our need for closeness creates a "dependency paradox." The more fully we can depend on our partner and trust them as our secure base, the more independent we can be.

- When we're attached to someone, we view them as our "secure base" and seek their support, both mentally and physically.
 - If we feel safe and secure, we feel empowered to explore, take risks, and achieve our goals.
 - If we feel insecure or threatened, we instinctively seek to restore a sense of safety.
- (i) Both children and adults show *"protest behaviors"* or *"activating strategies"* when separated from their attachment figures. Children might cry for an absent mother, while adults might seek reassurances or repeatedly call their partner on the phone. We find it hard to focus on other activities until our secure base is restored.
- (ii) When partners fail to meet each other's attachment needs, it can create *chronic tension and stress*, hurting their emotional and physical health.



Part 2: Understanding the 3 Attachment Styles

By understanding your attachment style and your partner's, you can gain insight into your respective needs and behaviors.



Secure Attachment Style



Overview: Individuals with a secure attachment style ("secure individuals") are comfortable with intimacy and are generally warm and loving. They find it easy to depend on others, and to have others depend on them. They do not worry constantly about being abandoned, nor about their partner getting too close. As a result, they generally report higher satisfaction, commitment, and trust in relationships.

KEY QUOTES

"Once we choose a partner, there is no question about whether dependency exists or not. It always does."

"Attachment principles teach us that most people are only as needy as their unmet needs."

"The need to be near someone special is so important that the brain has a biological mechanism specifically responsible for creating and regulating our connection with our attachment figures."

"In a true partnership, both partners view it as their responsibility to ensure the other's emotional well-being."

 People with a secure attachment style tend to demonstrate these traits and behaviors:

- They engage in open and direct communication. They express their needs, problems, and successes openly because they expect their partner to be loving and responsive.
- They are comfortable with both closeness and independence. They can read others' emotions, express themselves, and effectively provide and receive support. This tends to create a "buffering effect" to help an insecure partner feel more secure and satisfied with the relationship.
- They demonstrate high levels of trust and commitment in close relationships. They believe in their ability to strengthen a relationship and are committed to its growth. They don't see the need to "play games" or engage in a "relationship dance" of push-and-pull.
- They can resolve conflicts calmly and effectively, showing flexibility and openness to feedback. If they're treated disrespectfully, they tend to see it as a reflection of the other person's shortcomings, not their own self-worth. This allows them to move on without dwelling on the issue.



Anxious Attachment Style



Overview: Individuals with an anxious attachment style ("anxious individuals") crave intimacy but worry constantly about their relationship stability. They need constant reassurance, potentially leading to clingy or dependent behavior.

- Anxious individuals feel insecure in relationships. They are sensitive to shifts in their partner's moods or behaviors, tend to overthink them and misinterpret them as relationship threats. This triggers their attachment system, and they use activating strategies to reconnect, e.g. calling or texting their partner repeatedly.
 - (i) If the partner responds positively and quickly (e.g. texting to explain they can't take a call because they're in a meeting), they feel secure and return to their "safe zone".

KEY QUOTES

"What may come as hard work for some— to keep an even emotional keel in the face of threat—comes effortlessly for someone secure."

"Secure adults naturally know how to soothe their partners and take care of them—it's innate talent."

"Notice that if you feel unsettled in a relationship situation, all that is required is a minimal reassurance from your partner to get back on track."

- (ii) But if the issue drags on, their anxiety escalates and they enter the “*danger zone*”. They worry obsessively (e.g. thinking their partner is upset or even involved with someone else) and may take extreme measures to regain attention.

 In short, anxious people tend to demonstrate these traits and behaviors:

- They need frequent reassurance and validation. They become anxious when they’re not in contact with their partner, and can become clingy, jealous, or possessive.
- They tend to be overly-sensitive, overanalyzing interactions and reading too much into their partner’s actions/moods.
- Once their attachment system is triggered, they find it hard to “turn it off” without proper reassurances. They tend to engage in protest behaviors like excessive calling, keeping score, hostility, threatening to leave, or manipulation (e.g. acting busy/distant or trying to make their partner jealous). Such bids to regain attention can damage the relationship.



Avoidant Attachment Style



Overview: Individuals with an avoidant attachment style (“avoidant individuals”) value independence and often see intimacy as a threat to their freedom. They may be uncomfortable with closeness and tend to keep their partners at arm’s length. Avoidants usually find it hard to express their emotions and may come off as distant or emotionally unavailable.

- When a partner seems too close, avoidants use deactivating strategies to create distance. They might:
 - (i) Focus on their partners’ flaws and overlook their positive qualities;
 - (ii) Avoid discussing the relationship or committing to it;
 - (iii) Suppress emotions and pull away when things get too intimate; and/or
 - (iv) Flirt with others or pine for an ex.

KEY QUOTES

“Having a perpetually activated attachment system is the opposite of what nature had in mind for us in terms of gratifying love.”

“Protest behavior and activating strategies can cause you to act in ways that are harmful to the relationship. It is very important to learn to recognize them when they happen.”

“As an avoidant, you have a skewed perspective of the things that your partner says and does. The unnerving part is that you’re almost entirely unconscious of these unconstructive thought patterns.”

KEY QUOTES

"As an avoidant, your mind is governed by overarching perceptions and beliefs about relationships that ensure a disconnect with your partner and get in the way of your happiness."

"One of the consequences of devaluing your romantic relationship is that you often wake up long after the relationship has gone stale, having forgotten all those negative things that annoyed you about your partner, wondering what went wrong and reminiscing longingly about your long-lost love."

- To justify their emotional distance, avoidants tend to idealize a past partner, or believe there's a perfect partner out there who could meet their needs effortlessly.
 - (i) This gives them an excuse not to invest fully in the present relationship.
 - (ii) However, once they separate from a partner and distance themselves, they start to realize the positive qualities they had overlooked.
- Excessive self-reliance hampers their ability to connect or share intimacy, leading to less connectedness, warmth, and satisfaction in their relationships. They also tend to misinterpret their partner's attempts at closeness as clinginess, or perceive their partner's upsets as indifference.

 People with an avoidant attachment style tend to demonstrate these traits and behaviors:

- Prefer autonomy and maintain emotional distance;
- Avoid vulnerability, emotional dependence, or deep conversations about their feelings or the future; and
- Prioritize work, hobbies, or personal space over relationships or closeness.



Part 3: Nurturing Secure, Fulfilling Relationships

To nurture happy, fulfilling relationships, it's crucial to understand both you and your partner's attachment styles, adapt your responses effectively, and move toward a more secure relationship.



Identifying Your Respective Attachment Styles

 Identify the attachment styles for you and your partner, to better understand yourselves and manage your needs/responses, leading to happier and more fulfilling relationships.

 Refer to the list of traits/behaviors in the previous section, focusing on 2 attachment dimensions:

- Consider these 2 key dimensions: intimacy and anxiety.

(i) Intimacy: The extent to which you avoid intimacy and closeness; and

(ii) Anxiety: The extent to which you're preoccupied with your relationship and your partner's love or attention.



*Adapted from Brennan, Clark, and Shaver's scale

- Secure (low avoidance, low anxiety): You are comfortable with expressing your needs and affection, trust others, and are not easily bothered by minor issues.
- Anxious (low avoidance, high anxiety): You become quickly attached to romantic partners, are sensitive to your partner's moods, often worry that your partner will lose interest, and fear that people won't like you once they know the real you.
- Avoidant (high avoidance, low anxiety): You prioritize independence, avoid sharing feelings, struggle to support your partner emotionally, prefer casual relationships, and often feel annoyed at your partner for no clear reason.
- Anxious-Avoidant (high avoidance, high anxiety): You are anxious about your partner's availability, yet uncomfortable with intimacy.

Approximately 50% of people are secure, 20% are anxious, 25% are avoidant, and 3-5% are anxious-avoidant.



Use these 5 Golden Rules to assess your partners' behaviors:

- Do they seek intimacy or closeness? If yes, they're likely to be anxious or secure. If no, they are likely to be avoidant.
- Are they sensitive to and preoccupied with the relationship? If yes, they are likely to be anxious.
- How do they respond when you express your needs effectively? Secures accommodate your needs, anxious partners become more intimate, while avoidants react negatively.
- Look at multiple signs to assess the overall pattern. Don't just rely on 1 behavior.

KEY QUOTES

"Understanding attachment will change the way you perceive new people you meet, but it will also give you surprising insight into your partner if you are already in a relationship."

"What goes unsaid or undone by your partner can be just as informative as what he or she is doing and saying. Trust your gut feeling."

"There is no one characteristic that can establish someone's style but rather a combination of behaviors and attitudes that together create a coherent pattern. It is the whole picture that tells the true story."

- Don't just pay attention to what they say/do. Silence and inaction also reveal a lot about their true feelings and attachment style.



Adopt Effective Strategies Based On Your Attachment Style

Remember: there's no such thing as a "good" or "bad" style. Your needs are valid, and they can be fulfilled with the right partner.



If you have an anxious attachment style, recognize that your needs for intimacy, availability, and security are valid. Learn to express those needs effectively, and find a partner who can meet them.

- Don't follow popular dating advice like playing hard to get or appearing distant. These don't reflect your true need for intimacy, and will only attract the wrong type of partner.
- Adopt the "abundance philosophy." Realize that there are many potential partners who can meet your needs. Take your time to date different people and find someone truly compatible.
 - Ideally, pick a secure partner who's more likely to prioritize your well-being and provide the secure base you need. They might seem boring initially, but they also offer the stability and consistency you crave in a relationship.
 - Learn to spot avoidant partners who send mixed signals, constantly find faults with you, and disregard your feelings. Don't confuse drama with romance.
- Learn to express your needs clearly, rather than expect your partner to guess what you need/want. Don't overwhelm them with protest behaviors.
 - You're sensitive to your partner's emotional changes, but may misinterpret those emotions if you react too quickly.
 - So, take a moment to reflect on your partner's perspective instead of making assumptions. Give your partner some space to respond in their own time.



If you have an avoidant attachment style, learn to balance your need for independence with connectedness.

KEY QUOTES

"By being someone you're not, you're allowing another to be with you on his or her own terms and come and go as s/he pleases."

"The more you meet, the greater the chances you'll find the one who is a good match for you."

"Many people who live with insecure partners cannot even begin to imagine how fundamentally different life with a secure person can be."

"The beauty of effective communication is that it allows you to turn a supposed weakness into an asset."

KEY QUOTES

"If we overrate self-reliance, we diminish the importance of getting support from other people, thus cutting ourselves off from an important lifeline."

"The more attuned you are to your partner's needs at the early stages—and he or she to yours—the less energy you will need to expend attending to him or her later."

"If you want to take the road to independence and happiness, first find the right person to depend on and travel down it with them."

"If you're with someone secure, they nurture you into a more secure stance."

"Just because you can get along with anyone doesn't mean you have to."

- Express your needs for personal space and autonomy, but remember that extreme self-reliance can lead to loneliness and less satisfying relationships.
- Mutual support leads to more fulfilling connections. When both partners feel secure, there's also less need for distance or clinginess.
- Ideally, choose a secure partner who can respect your need for personal space while gently encouraging emotional closeness.
- Recognize your deactivating strategies. For example, if you find yourself idealizing an ex, remind yourself why that relationship wasn't right. Stop searching for the "perfect partner" who will meet all your ideals.
- Instead of fixating on your partner's flaws or imperfections, focus on positive aspects of your partner and relationship.
 - (i) Make a daily list of things you appreciate about your partner.
 - (ii) Trust that your partner has your best interests at heart.
- Use shared activities to connect without feeling overwhelmed. Activities like hiking, cooking, or watching movies together some distractions to help you feel closer without the pressure of direct emotional intimacy.



If you have a secure attachment style, you can probably sustain satisfying relationships with people of any attachment style. You can even help anxious or avoidant partners to become more secure over time by providing consistent support and comfort.

- Seek to create a "secure base" for your partner. This helps anxious partners to feel reassured and encourages avoidant partners to open up gradually.
- However, beware of staying too long in an unhealthy relationship due to your forgiving nature and sense of duty.
 - (i) Feelings of anxiety, jealousy, or avoidance are all signs that your secure foundation has been shaken.
 - (ii) If unhappiness persists despite your best efforts to address the issues, it's often better to end the relationship.



Adapting To Your Partner's Attachment Style

If you're still unattached, choose a partner with a secure style. If you're already in a relationship with an anxious or avoidant partner, then adapt to your partner's style to improve the relationship dynamics.



If your partner has an anxious style:

- Check-in regularly and consistently to give them the assurance and attention they crave. This could be as simple as verbal affirmations or simple text messages to let them know you're thinking of them.
- Be more open and honest in your communications, expressing your feelings and intentions clearly to avoid misunderstandings.



If your partner has an avoidant style:

- Respect their need for space and time alone; don't take it personally, and don't rush intimacy or emotional closeness.
- Use straightforward language to help them understand your needs and feelings without feeling pressured.
- Regularly highlight positive aspects of your relationship and shared experiences.



Navigating the Anxious-Avoidant Trap



The worst conflicts often occur when one partner is anxious and the other is avoidant. The anxious partner needs closeness and reassurance, which conflicts with the avoidant partner's need for distance and autonomy. This creates an anxious-avoidant trap.

- Such conflicting intimacy needs lead to misunderstandings, frustrations and dissatisfaction on both sides.
 - (i) The closer the anxious partner gets and the needier they seem, the more the avoidant partner withdraws or responds with hostility, making the anxious partner feel rejected and undervalued.

KEY QUOTES

"The trick is not to get hooked on the highs and lows and mistake an activated attachment system for passion or love. Don't let emotional unavailability turn you on."

"True love, in the evolutionary sense, means peace of mind. 'Still waters run deep' is a good way of characterizing it."

*"All happiness or unhappiness solely depends upon the quality of the object to which we are attached by love."
—Baruch Spinoza*

"When the two people in a couple have colliding intimacy needs, their relationship is likely to become more of a storm-tossed voyage than a safe haven."

(ii) The tension builds up, leading to frequent fights over seemingly-trivial issues. Both sides experience an emotional roller-coaster of intense highs and lows.

- There's also emotional counterbalancing at play, as avoidants inflate their self-esteem and independence by comparing themselves to their dependent, anxious partners.



Strategies to improve the relationship.

- Create a relationship inventory to understand how your attachment style affects your relationships, so you can work towards a more secure style.
 - (i) List down the names of your past and present romantic partners to identify wider patterns.
 - (ii) What are the key memories and characteristics that stand out for each relationship?
 - (iii) What were the specific situations that triggered your need for closeness (if you're anxious) or your need for distance (if you're avoidant)?
 - (iv) What were your specific thoughts, actions, and feelings in response to these situations?
 - (v) What underlying patterns, insecurities, or attachment issues can you identify?
 - (vi) How did these attachment-driven reactions impact your happiness and relationship satisfaction?
 - (vii) Who are the secure role models you can learn from (e.g. a family member who can express their feelings calmly and constructively)? Focus on specific beliefs, attitudes, behaviors or traits you can emulate.
- Review your relationship inventory with a primary attachment figure or someone you trust for emotional support (e.g. a family member or therapist).
- With clarity and awareness, you can communicate your needs more clearly, without attacking or blaming your partner.
- Establish clear boundaries (e.g. acceptable levels of closeness and independence) to manage expectations and reduce overwhelm. For example:

KEY QUOTES

"Attachment styles are stable but plastic. This means that they tend to stay consistent over time, but they can also change."

"As a person's attachment style gradually changes toward greater security, he or she behaves more constructively in relationships and even enjoys better mental and physical health. And if both partners are able to do so—the results can be remarkable."

KEY QUOTES

- (i) Instead of bombarding your partner with texts, you might agree on 2 simple check-ins daily so you can feel reassured without overwhelming your partner.
- (ii) If you feel suffocated with too much 1-1 time, try agreeing on specific times in the week when you can engage in shared activities, e.g. taking walks or watching a movie.



Intimacy clashes are rarely resolved. Even if the relationship lasts a long time, it remains unstable. Couples stuck in the anxious-avoidant trap may experience chronic dissatisfaction that damages their mental-emotional health and spills over to other aspects of life e.g. sleeping habits or parenting.

- If necessary, seek professional help.
- You can choose to compromise by adjusting your expectations, but this often leads to lower relationship satisfaction.
- If things don't improve despite your best efforts, it might be better to end the relationship, especially if you're in a new or uncommitted relationship.



Even if you know you should end the relationship, you might find it hard to do so.

- A breakup is painful, and it's common to experience a "rebound" as you crave comfort from your ex to soothe the emotional pain. Positive memories may also overshadow the negatives, strengthening the emotional pull toward your ex.
- Here are some strategies to survive a breakup:
 - (i) Build a support network of family and friends who can offer emotional support and soothe your attachment needs straight after a breakup. Try staying temporarily with someone you trust, to reduce feelings of loneliness.
 - (ii) Write down all the reasons why you left the relationship. When you feel the urge to revive the relationship, ask your friends/family to remind you of those reasons.
 - (iii) Be kind to yourself if you slip and rebound. Acknowledge your pain, and trust that it will eventually pass, and you can move on to a healthier relationship.

"Our memories are not like old books in the library, lying there dusty and unchanged; they are rather like a living, breathing entity. What we remember today of our past is in fact a product of editing and reshaping that occurs over the years whenever we recall that particular memory."

"You may understand rationally that you should leave, but your emotional brain may not yet be ready to make that move."

"The fact that one person can take away all our discomfort in a split second makes it very hard to resist the temptation to see him or her again."

"The worse you feel about yourself, the more you'll want to go back to the false safety of the bad relationship you were in."



Improving Communications for Relationship Success



Effective communication helps you to (i) choose the right partner who can meet your needs and (ii) ensure those needs are met.



Here are several important communication principles:

- Be honest, authentic, and unapologetic about your needs and feelings, recognizing that your attachment needs are key to your happiness.
- Use phrases like "need," "feel," and "want" to express your needs clearly without blaming your partner. For example: "I love you very much. I need to know that you're there for me all the time. And I need to be able to talk to you daily, not just when it's convenient for you. I don't want to hide my desire to be close to you, for fear of driving you away."
- Be specific about what's bothering you, e.g. "I feel disconnected and anxious when I don't hear from you daily."



If necessary, draft a script in advance. This helps you to reflect on what specifically what makes you uneasy, and what you need to feel more secure. Seek help from someone with a secure attachment style, and rehearse your message until you're confident.

- Example: Let's imagine your partner frequently cancels plans last minute, making you feel like an afterthought.
 - (i) It's *ineffective* to give them the silent treatment to show your displeasure, hoping they'll figure out why you're upset.
 - (ii) It's more *effective* to address it directly, e.g. "It's disappointing when our plans are canceled last minute. I look forward to our time together, and I need to know that you prioritize spending time with me. Can we find a way to make our plans more consistent?"

KEY QUOTES

"Your date's response to effective communication can reveal more in five minutes than you could learn in months of dating without this kind of discourse."

"Ineffective communication can be interpreted in different ways while effective communication has only one specific meaning."

"Worries and fears surface more when you are not communicating your concerns and are letting things build up."

"When it comes to attachment style, we're malleable. And it's never too late to learn new relationship skills."



Resolving Everyday Conflicts in a Secure Way



All couples, even secure ones, experience conflicts. However, their impact depends on the type of issues involved, and how the conflict is handled.

- Unlike intimacy conflicts (which are more challenging), bread-and-butter conflicts involve everyday issues like choosing what to do or eat. Handled properly, they can help couples to consider each other's perspectives and bring them closer together.



Use these learnable principles for conflict resolution:

- To resolve conflicts constructively, always assume the best in your partner and show concern for their well-being. Recognize that their happiness and well-being are interconnected with yours.
- Focus on the problem at hand. Do not (i) launch into personal attacks, or (ii) generalize and let the issue spill over into other areas of the relationship.
- Stay present—both physically and emotionally—to show that you're willing to resolve the issue together.
- Clearly articulate your needs and feelings. Don't expect your partner to guess them.



Our brain releases oxytocin—a hormone that strengthens bonds—during orgasm or when we cuddle. Prioritize quality time for healthy boosts of oxytocin to minimize the occurrence of conflicts.



Conclusion and Other Details in the Book



Regardless of your current attachment style, you can learn to adopt a secure communication style for healthier, more fulfilling connections.



Beyond the concepts in this summary, the book offers many other tools to help you apply the insights in your life, such as: real-life examples of couples who have overcome relationship

KEY QUOTES

"What does differentiate between couples and affect their satisfaction levels in their relationships is not how much they disagree, but how they disagree and what they disagree about."

"We often view conflict as a zero-sum game...attachment theory shows us that our happiness is actually dependent on our mate's and vice versa."

"When there's a willingness to resolve a specific problem, people feel that they're being heard and it brings both parties closer together."

"The first step toward applying attachment theory to your life is to get to know yourself and those around you from an attachment perspective."

challenges, interactive exercises to explore your own attachment style, and a detailed questionnaire to identify your attachment type. For more information, visit www.attachedthebook.com.



About the Author

Amir Levine, M.D. is a psychiatrist, neuroscientist, and associate professor of psychiatry and director of the SecureLab at Columbia University. He specializes in attachment-based treatments and supervises therapists globally. He also has a private practice where he consults with individuals, couples, and families. His research and clinical work have significantly contributed to the development of adult attachment theory, especially how different attachment styles affect romantic relationships.



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KEY QUOTES